

# SURF vs NAPA: TACTICAL REVIEW

River Islands Surf U16 | 1-3-5-2 | Coaching priorities and film evidence

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## Main assessment

Surf shows useful inside and deeper support, forward carrying, and willingness to challenge. The clearest repeated issue is converting engagement into control: protect the next passing route and secure the ball after the first challenge.

### ● GREEN | Retain

Preserve forward intent when space opens and use a deeper teammate when the forward route closes. Examples: Part 2, 12:24-12:53 and 15:30-15:59.

### ● YELLOW | Refine

Support exists in selected passages, but the receiving space can become crowded. Improve separation, receiving angles and movement after the pass. Example: Part 4, 10:40-11:09.

### ● RED | Priority to address

Several passages show Surf contesting while Napa keeps or moves the ball onward. Give nearby defenders distinct responsibilities: pressure, cover the next pass, anticipate the loose ball.

## Two team priorities

1. Give the next receiver a usable passing option away from pressure.
2. Connect every challenge to cover and readiness for the next ball.

## Scope and confidence

This report consolidates the expanded four-part review and the additional player-report sequences. The prior survey used five-second sequential frames, with selected passages checked at one-second intervals. It is not continuous playback or an exhaustive event count. Dots identify behaviors and coaching priorities, not individual or match-wide grades. Times restart in each video part.

# POSSESSION: ATTRACT AND ESCAPE

Evidence first; tactical applications are coaching recommendations

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## ● GREEN | Deeper support creates another route

Part 2, 12:24-12:53: after a near-side contest, Surf uses a deeper receiver as Napa approaches, then returns play forward. Part 1, 16:08-16:16 provides another release under approaching pressure. These support the reset principle; they do not verify a repeated back-three-to-6-to-interior pattern.

## ● GREEN | Carry into available space

Part 2, 15:30-15:59: a Surf carrier advances through midfield with teammates ahead. Later contact and a stoppage limit the attack outcome. Preserve the carry when opponents leave a clear route, with an option ahead and a safe pass behind.

## ● YELLOW | Connection must create room

Part 4, 10:40-11:09: an inside teammate is available to the near-right receiver, but the inward action becomes crowded. The issue is the usefulness of the angle and next reception, rather than simply an absence of support.

## Coaching application in the 1-3-5-2

Wingback and nearest interior form separate passing angles. The original passer moves again after release. The 6 offers support behind the ball while another midfielder can move higher. Attract pressure only while an escape pass remains available.



Part 4, 10:52 | Inside support exists.

**Coach question:** Does the receiving angle move the ball away from the defender, or into the same crowd?

# DEFENDING: PRESSURE WITH COVER

The first challenge must connect to the next action

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## ● **RED | Repeated escape after engagement**

Prior checked passages: Part 1, 4:08-4:23; Part 2, 11:24-11:39; Part 3, 10:44-11:15. Surf engages around the ball, while Napa retains or escapes. The added Part 2, 6:40-7:09 and Part 4, 14:10-14:39 examples reinforce this coaching concern.

## ● **YELLOW | Separate the local responsibilities**

Part 4, 17:05-17:34: Surf engages in midfield without establishing controlled possession before Napa moves onward. The second defender should protect the next route rather than duplicate the first challenge.

## **Coaching response**

Nearest defender pressures or delays. Second defender blocks the likely escape pass. Another player prepares for the loose ball. Keep central protection behind the group. If pressure cannot influence possession, recover toward the middle together.

## **Classification limit**

Some passages are loose-ball contests with uncertain preceding possession. They are not all classified as counter-presses. Part 3, 11:00-11:15 includes Napa possession and must not be presented as a clean Surf regain followed by progression.



Part 2, 6:48 | Napa moves the ball on.

**Coach question:** Who protects the next pass while the first defender challenges?

# POSITIONAL APPLICATION

Role guidance | Avoid individual grades where roles cannot be tracked reliably

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## Goalkeeper and back three

Use the free teammate when the forward route is closed. Prepare the next pass before receiving. Move together with progression. If one defender steps, rebalance the remaining protection. The film does not establish consistent buildup patterns across the match.

## 6 / 8 / 10 relationships

Some reset passages show separate depths; contested actions show convergence. Coach different heights and angles: support behind, a connecting option, and a higher option when appropriate. Exact shirt numbers and role assignments are too uncertain for individual assessment.

## Wingbacks and nearest interior

Retain the available inside connection seen in Part 4. Refine the distance and angle so the receiver can play outside the same pressure. Include the wingback's movement after the pass, rather than treating release as the end of the action.

## Two forwards and attacking spacing

Part 2 shows teammates ahead of the advancing carrier. Complementary checking and depth runs by both forwards are not reliably resolved. Coaching target: one connection to feet, one threat behind, and midfield support traveling with the attack.

## Block defending and 3+1 rest defense

Part 1, 18:45-19:14 shows Surf players between Napa and the right-side goal during circulation. This establishes defensive presence, not verified compactness distances. The complete back-three-plus-6 picture at attacking losses is not consistently visible; its reliability remains ungraded.

# GROWTH AGAINST NEWARK PRIORITIES

Comparison to documented priorities | No measured improvement rating

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## Collective pressure

Newark priority: support the nearest pressure by blocking the next pass.

**Napa evidence:** several players engage locally, but clean pressure-cover coordination remains unresolved or ineffective in the cited contests.

**Assessment:** engagement is present; controlled collective pressure remains the priority.

## Wide-to-inside connection

Newark priority: prevent wide receivers becoming separated from interior support.

**Napa evidence:** Part 4 has an available inside teammate; Part 1 and Part 2 show resets away from immediate pressure.

**Assessment:** the desired connection appears in examples. Improve the receiving space and next pass.

## Connected progression

Newark priority: forward receivers need support traveling with the pass.

**Napa evidence:** Part 2 includes forward carrying and advancing teammates.

**Assessment:** encouraging examples aligned with the training work; repeatability is unmeasured.

## Midfield heights and central protection

Newark priority: stagger the 6/8/10 and retain connected back-three-plus-6 protection.

**Napa evidence:** complete positional relationships are not reliably established.

**Assessment:** insufficient evidence for a progress judgment.

## How to measure the next step

Code comparable passages from both games: pressured receptions with a usable support option; escape passes followed by retained possession; challenges with cover of the next outlet; regains followed by a controlled action. No percentages have been calculated here. The Newark baseline comes from its previous report, not a matched re-review.

# FILM SEQUENCE INDEX

Use local part timestamps to locate the passages

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## ● GREEN | Useful support and progression

Part 1, 15:00-15:10: inward reset; stoppage limits continuation.

Part 1, 16:08-16:16: deeper receiver releases as pressure approaches.

Part 2, 2:24-2:43: deeper reception followed by forward movement.

Part 2, 12:24-12:53: deeper reset and return forward.

Part 2, 15:30-15:59: carry through midfield; later contact and stoppage.

Part 4, 19:05-19:34: forward intent after exchanges; no clean-regain count assigned.

## ● YELLOW | Support angle and shared responsibilities

Part 4, 10:40-11:09: inside option followed by congestion.

Part 4, 17:05-17:34: local engagement without secure Surf possession.

## ● RED | Protect the next pass and loose ball

Part 1, 4:08-4:23: Napa emerges toward near-right channel.

Part 2, 6:40-7:09: Surf contests; Napa moves on and retains.

Part 2, 11:24-11:39: engagement with Napa retention or escape.

Part 3, 10:44-11:15: aerial and loose-ball exchanges; Napa possession visible.

Part 4, 14:10-14:39: challenges without a clear sustained Surf regain.

## Additional context

Part 1, 18:45-19:14: defensive presence during Napa circulation; use for discussion, not a compactness or rest-defense rating. Screenshots illustrate one moment; consult the whole cited passage before attributing an error.

# TRAINING TRANSFER AND NEXT REVIEW

Deceptive possession | Coaching applications for the next training block

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## Possession objective

Draw an opponent toward the ball, then release through a different angle. Reward an escape only when the receiver can control and continue. Use a backward reset as a deliberate route to the next forward action, rather than forcing the first opening.

## Transition objective

Connect pressure to cover. Reward a controlled regain and next pass, rather than contact alone. In loose-ball situations, identify the challenger, the player protecting the exit, and the player anticipating the next ball.

## What the coach should watch

Does the support player move before the ball arrives? Does the passer offer another option after release? Does the second defender block a likely pass? After recovery, can Surf retain or progress with the next action?

## Player language

"Give a clear pass."

"Pass, then help again."

"One pressures; one blocks the pass."

"Be ready after the tackle."

"If we cannot win it, protect the middle."

## Evidence and limits

Sources: coach-supplied U16 Parts 1-4; current expanded U16 vs Napa tactical report; the six sequences in the revised player breakdown. The Newark comparison retains its documented priorities. U15 material supplied the presentation reference only. Sequential-frame inspection can miss brief touches and off-camera runs. Recommendations are coaching applications; unsupported positional ratings and individual blame are excluded.